

## Government to revisit preferential policy for electronics manufacturing

The government of India intends to re-evaluate the preferential market access (PMA) policy that favoured locally-manufactured electronics goods in government and private sector procurement. The decision to review the policy came after protests by various trade groups hailing from global companies including Apple Inc. It is worth mentioning here that the Cabinet approved the policy last year citing national security.

In a statement on July 8, the PMO said, "No notifications on PMA in the private sector on security related products will be issued till the PMA Policy is reviewed and any notifications in the draft stage will be withheld." It further added, "The overall policy on PMA will be recalibrated and submitted to the Cabinet." As per the statement, the National Security Council Secretariat will provide a definition of 'security' for usage in the context of security related issues concerning products, projects or sectors.

## Electronic manufacturers get three more months for BIS certification

Electronic manufacturing companies in India get three more months to register their products with the BIS certification. The previous deadline of July 3 was also an extension of an April deadline. The companies that still remain to submit their application for registration and tests will now need to pay double the amount, a fee of Rs 25,000.

As per the earlier order, these companies were required to get 15 of their information technology and electronic goods registered with the Bureau of Indian Standards. According to J. Satyanarayana, the secretary for the Department of Electronics and

## Bobby Mitra named TI's worldwide director



Dr Biswadip

Dr Biswadip (Bobby) Mitra has been appointed worldwide director for TI's industrial systems, and will relocate to the United States. He has also been named chairman of TI India.



Santhosh Kumar

Whereas Santhosh Kumar has been appointed the new managing director for TI's operations in India and he will relocate to India from the US.

## Exide Industries appoints PK Katak as MD, CEO

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PK Katak, former director, automotive, Exide, as managing director and CEO. The company has also made changes in its board of directors by appointing Gautam Chatterjee as joint managing director and Subir Chakraborty as an additional and full-time director.

## Ramesh Rajan resigns from PWC

Ramesh Rajan, the former chairman of Pricewaterhouse Coopers India entities has resigned after having been with PWC for over three decades. Ramesh Rajan was the first elected chairman and senior partner of the company. Rajan has resigned from PWC effective June 30.

IT (DietY), "The companies that still remain will now have to pay double as a penalty as the processing fee for the BIS certification."

## Export incentives for Hi-tech electronics products from 15th August

Under the Focus Product Scheme, hi-tech products from engineering, electronics, chemical and pharmaceuticals sectors will be able to avail export incentives. With the objective of promoting products that have high export intensity and employment potential, 158 hi-tech items will be provided in-

centives from August 15. The Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) will separately notify the detailed list of the 158 selected products that will be entitled to duty credit scrips worth two per cent of the exported value.

Commerce and Industry Minister Anand Sharma had announced the decision to incentivise exports of high-tech products on April 18 in the Foreign Trade Policy of this year.

## Smartphone shipments grown by 167 per cent in India

According to a report from research firm Cyber Media Research, smart-

phone shipments in India increased by 167 per cent from last year. Nearly 10 million smartphones were shipped within the country between January and February this year thanks to the new launches from Samsung Electronics and other cheap phones flooding the market.

